

OREGON STATE HOSPITAL

POLICY

SECTION 6: Patient Care **POLICY: 6.042**

SUBJECT: Short-Term Assessment of Risk and Treatability (START)

POINT PERSON: Chief of Psychology

APPROVED: Sara Walker, MD

Interim Superintendent



DATE: JULY 31, 2024

SELECT ONE: ☐ New policy

☒ Minor/technical revision of existing policy

☐ Reaffirmation of existing policy

☐ Major revision of existing policy

I. PURPOSE AND APPLICABILITY

- A. This policy establishes Oregon State Hospital (OSH)'s use of the Short-Term Assessment of Risk and Treatability (START) tool.
- B. This policy applies to all staff.

II. POLICY

- A. OSH will assess a patient's risk to inform treatment planning. OSH will use the START tool to guide decisions for a patient's supervision levels, including but not limited to changes to privileges. Assessed risk will include risk of violence, self-harm, suicide, unauthorized leave, substance abuse, self-neglect, being victimized, and other case-specific risks.
- B. A START must be completed on all patients committed to OSH, with the possible exception of patients with pending legal charges and/or committed under Oregon Revised Statute 161.370 or 161.365.
 - 1. Note: If a patient is under dual jurisdiction, i.e., a patient who is civilly committed with pending charges, a START will not be completed. The psychology department must assess patient commitment status to determine if a START is required.
- C. The interdisciplinary treatment team (IDT) is responsible to collaboratively score the START and its supporting information. The START must be completed as delineated in the START Manual (Webster et al., 2009) and updated after any significant event indicating a substantial change in the patient's current or anticipated level of risk.

- D. The psychologist or another licensed independent practitioner appointed by the Chief of Psychology is responsible to coordinate START scoring discussions. At minimum, three IDT members must be present to score the START. (Other staff may submit their clinical impressions to the IDT.)
- E. Staff scoring the START must immediately initiate necessary safety and risk management measures if one or more of the three T.H.R.E.A.T. (Threat of Harm that is Real, Enactable, Acute and Targeted) boxes is checked.
- F. Only the Chief of Psychology may grant an exception to scoring the START without a psychologist present or to having fewer than three IDT members present.
- G. The risk levels delineated in the START are invalid after 90 days from completion of the START.
- H. The unit psychologist or designated staff will complete the narrative sections of the START following patient admission. The IDT will then collaboratively score the START by 60 days of admission.
- I. If a patient is transferred to a new unit within 21 calendar days from admission, the receiving IDT must collaborate with the sending IDT to complete the START.
- J. A START must be completed before Risk Review or a Conditional Release hearing. The IDT referring a patient for Risk Review or Conditional Release hearing must complete the START unless the patient was transferred to the referring IDT's unit within seven days before the referral to Risk Review or Conditional Release hearing. In such cases, the receiving IDT must collaborate with the sending IDT to complete the START.
- K. A START must be completed whenever new risks are identified.
- L. OSH follows all applicable regulations, including federal and state statutes and rules; Oregon Department of Administrative Services (DAS), Shared Services, and Oregon Health Authority (OHA) policies; and relevant accreditation standards. Such regulations supersede the provisions of this policy unless this policy is more restrictive.
- M. Staff who fail to comply with this policy or related policy attachments or protocols may be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including dismissal.

III. DEFINITIONS

- A. "Staff" includes employees, volunteers, trainees, interns, contractors, vendors, and other state employees assigned to work at Oregon State Hospital (OSH).

IV. RELATED OSH POLICIES AND PROTOCOLS

6.001 Patient Transfers

6.006 On-grounds and Off-grounds Movement

6.010 Enhanced Supervision

6.024 Transportation and Supervision Ratios

6.029 Risk Review and Privileges

6.058 Admissions

V. REFERENCES

Oregon Administrative Rule § 309-120-0080.

Oregon Revised Statute §§ 161.327 — 161.328.

Oregon Revised Statute § 420.505.

Oregon Revised Statute § 426.220.

Oregon Revised Statute § 426.225.

Oregon Revised Statutes §§ 426.650 — 426.675.

Oregon Revised Statute § 426.701.

Webster, C.D., Martin, M., Brink, J., Nicholls, T.L., Desmarais, S.I. (2009). *Short-term assessment of risk and treatability (START)* (Version 1.1). British Columbia Mental Health and Addiction Services.